GOOGLE CLOUD AI BUILDER CUP 2026 · RETAIL & COMMERCE

SKUdesk

One agent that buys cheapest, helps you sell, and finds arbitrage. Only for the identical product.

If nothing is provably the same item, or no gap survives the costs, it says no. A person approves every spend.

Live: skudesk-ij5vrivnta-as.a.run.app

github.com/johnnyduo/SKUdesk_

THE PROBLEM

Price comparison breaks the moment two listings are not the same thing.

We searched Google Shopping for **LEGO 10294 Titanic**. It returned 36 listings. Among them:

- Light kits and spare parts that name the set
- Generic "building blocks" reusing the set number
- Used and opened boxes
- Real sets listed at **$11** and **$19** against a $679.99 retail price

What goes wrong

A naive agent "finds" a 2,000% margin on a $21 Titanic and recommends buying it. The cheapest price is usually the wrong product, or not a real price.

Arbitrage and buying agents are only as good as their idea of "same".

HOW IT WORKS

One gate decides what counts as the same item. Everything else is arithmetic.

1 · SEARCH

Google Shopping via SerpApi, eBay API ready. Every paid call cached; monthly cap.

2 · IDENTITY GATE

Gemini compares each listing with the product. It must **quote** the brand and set number from both listings.

3 · PRICE SANITY

Same product, believable price? Far below median or below half of retail is set aside.

4 · ECONOMICS

Integer-cent landed cost, fees, shipping, margin floor. Verdict or an honest no.

5 · APPROVAL

The agent files a pending proposal. A person approves. No payment details held.

Buy, sell and arbitrage are three views of the same verified set of identical offers.

GEN AI, DONE CAREFULLY

The model is not trusted. Its evidence is checked.

Running the gate on real listings exposed a failure our hand-made eval missed: the model credited listings with a **"LEGO"** brand they never wrote, and passed generic blocks that reuse a set number.

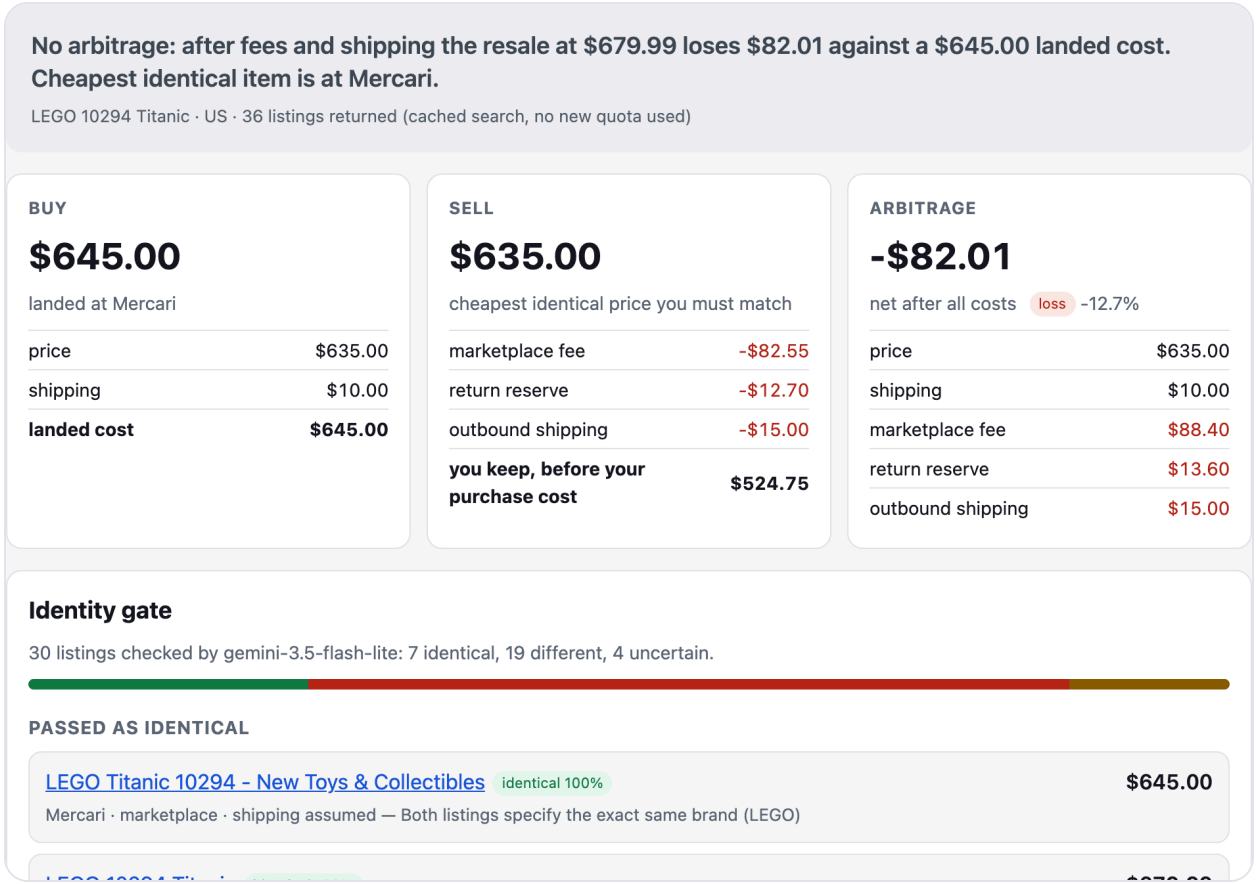
Fix: Gemini must copy the brand and identifier out of each listing. **Code verifies the quotes are really in the text**. Anything it cannot back up becomes "uncertain" and never passes. Errors fail closed.

Defences, all tested

- Verbatim evidence check on brand and identifier
- Listing text treated as untrusted (injection pairs in the eval)
- Price sanity against Gemini's recalled retail price, flagged as recalled, not live
- "Too good to be true" above a 50% margin

LIVE RESULT · TITANIC

The honest answer is often "no arbitrage". Here is why.



No arbitrage: after fees and shipping the resale at $679.99 loses $82.01 against a $645.00 landed cost. Cheapest identical item is at Mercari.

LEGO 10294 Titanic · US · 36 listings returned (cached search, no new quota used)

BUY		SELL		ARBITRAGE	
$645.00		**$635.00**		**-$82.01**	
landed at Mercari		cheapest identical price you must match		net after all costs loss -12.7%	
price	$635.00	marketplace fee	-$82.55	price	$635.00
shipping	$10.00	return reserve	-$12.70	shipping	$10.00
landed cost	**$645.00**	outbound shipping	-$15.00	marketplace fee	$88.40
		you keep, before your purchase cost	**$524.75**	return reserve	$13.60
				outbound shipping	$15.00

Identity gate

30 listings checked by gemini-3.5-flash-lite: 7 identical, 19 different, 4 uncertain.

PASSED AS IDENTICAL

LEGO Titanic 10294 - New Toys & Collectibles identical 100% — $645.00

Mercari · marketplace · shipping assumed — Both listings specify the exact same brand (LEGO)

30 listings checked, **7 identical**, 19 different, 4 uncertain.

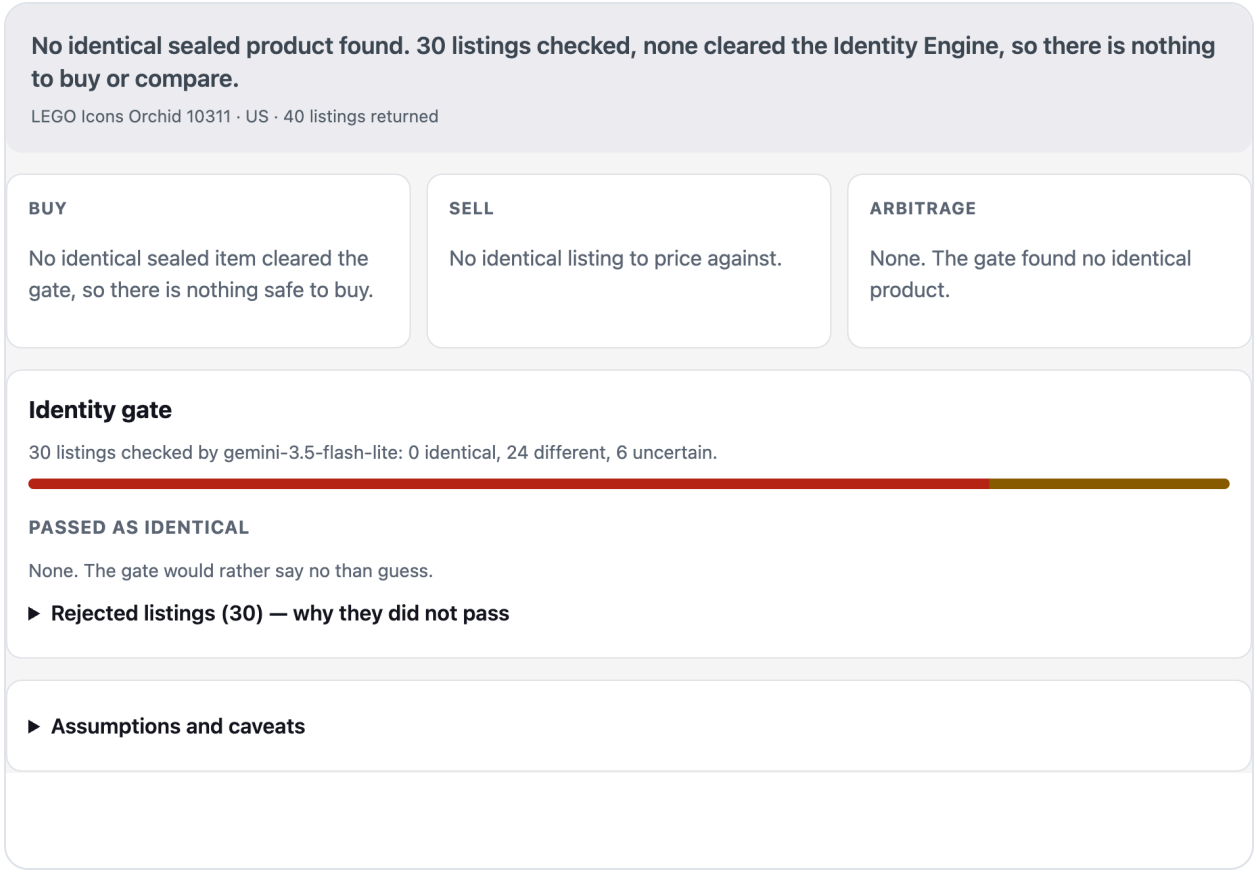
Two "identical" offers at $11 and $19 are **set aside** as bad prices.

Cheapest real offer: **$645 landed**. Resale at the next price loses **$82.01**.

Asking prices, not sold prices. Fees, return reserve and shipping are shown and editable assumptions.

LIVE RESULT · ORCHID

When nothing is provably the same, the agent buys nothing.



30 listings for **LEGO Icons Orchid 10311**. **Zero** cleared the gate.

Before the evidence check, a "866 PCS Creative Bouquet" building-block set reusing the number 10311 passed as identical. Now it does not.

No proposal is filed. Nothing is offered for approval.

EVIDENCE

43 hand-labelled pairs, run against real Gemini. The number that matters is zero.

0

false-identical: pairs that should not match but passed the gate.

41 of 43 exact. The other 2 were labelled different and answered "uncertain", which is the safe side.

Said plainly

- Most listing texts are hand-written to look like marketplace titles; 5 are real titles from the day we found the leak
- Labels come from LEGO set numbers
- No GTIN pairs and no image inputs yet
- 43 pairs is a small sample, not a guarantee

BUILT ON GOOGLE CLOUD

Small, real and deployed. Plain web2 end to end.

PART	ROLE	STATE
Gemini 3.5 Flash-Lite	Identity gate, retail price recall	live
Cloud Run	API and one-page UI, deployed from source	live
Firestore	Cache, analyses, proposals, scan log	live
Cloud Scheduler	Daily watchlist scan, secret-protected	live
Secret Manager	API keys, least-privilege service account	live
eBay Browse API	Second source	written, not run against live API
Payments	Approval is a decision log, not a purchase	not built, on purpose

IMPACT AND NEXT

Retail teams lose money on "the same item" that was not.

- **Now:** sealed LEGO, US market, five markets selectable
- **Next:** GTIN and image evidence, eBay sold-price data, more categories where identity is checkable
- **Principle:** the agent's value is knowing when to say no, and showing its evidence when it says yes

Try it: skudesk-ij5vrivnta-as.a.run.app · **Code:** github.com/johnnyduo/SKUdesk_

The concept builds on the team's earlier work; all code and assets here were written new for this competition.